Why the Month Day Format is not only absurd but also a wrong date format – a proof by contradiction

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Abstract

The date above is wrong. It is not a correct representation of the actual date, which is 2026-03-11, or the 11th of March, 2026. This is why.[1]

Keywords: Worst, date, format, ever, proof

1 Introduction

Many people ask themselves, *What is the best date*? While answers may vary, as this might be subjective, within this article, the author proves that the date as displayed above (*March 11*) *is wrong*, making it the worst of the common dates. Also called the *'American absurdity'* (MineralPlunder, 2019), Month Day is widely recognised as the worst date format. That it is also objectively wrong is proven in this article.

2 Proof

Assume 11th of March, 2026 is today's date, and let's agree this is correct. Let's also consider Mary, who (famously) has a little lamb (and disregard that we don't know how the lamb feels about being possessed by Mary).

If 11th of March is a true statement, so is the little lamb of Mary.

Let's rearrange:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{little lamb of Mary} &= \text{Mary's little lamb} \\ \text{Mary's little lamb} &= \text{little lamb of Mary} \\ 11^{\text{th}} \text{ of March} &= \text{March's } 11^{\text{th}} \end{aligned}$$

[1] Link to the most recent version of this article: `https://raw.githubusercontent.com/brueckmann/Proof_MonthDayYearIsWrong/refs/heads/main/Proof_MonthDayYearIsWrong.pdf`

Now, take the case of March 11 in order to prove by contradiction and suppose:

$$11^{\text{th}} \text{ of March} = \text{March } 11$$
$$\text{But as:}$$
$$\text{little lamb of Mary} \neq \text{Mary little lamb}$$

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Given *Mary little lamb* is so ambiguous that you may wonder if the author is under the influence, one can confidently refute the claim that March 11 is a valid date.

3 Conclusion

We can confidently conclude that March 11 is not equivalent to today's date, which is 2026-03-11, the best date format IMHO, and ISO 8601:2000 agrees with me. Given the proof in this paper, we should retire the Month Day Year date format, once and for all.

References

ISO 8601:2000(E) (2019). PDate and time – Representations for information interchange Part 1: Basic rules. Standard, International Organization for Standardization, Geneva, CH.

MineralPlunder (2019). A correction of fixed version of a certain diagram comparing pyramids of date formats. `https://www.reddit.com/r/ISO8601/comments/aafikk/a_correction_of_fixed_version_of_a_certain/`. [Accessed 11-03-2026].

Link to the most recent version: `github/brueckmann/Proof_MonthDayYearIsWrong/2 blob/main/Proof_MonthDayYearIsWrong.pdf`